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Interaction between user-interface and instrument motion controller

Abstract

A method is provided to control actuation of a click event by a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to a mount structure, comprising: in a first control state, imparting a maintaining force to the hand-actuated selector; in a second control state, imparting a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that increases as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position; imparting a click event signal to cause an occurrence of the click event at a display system, in a third control state, imparting a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases in magnitude to a reduced magnitude.

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Background/Summary

CLAIM OF PRIORITY (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/039,706 filed on May 31, 2023, which is a U.S. National Stage Filing under 35 U.S.C. 371 from International Application No. PCT/US2021/060400, filed on Nov. 22, 2021, and published as WO 2022/119740 A1 on Jun. 9, 2022, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/120,202, filed on Dec. 1, 2020, and to U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/187,879, filed on May 12, 2021, each of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Minimally invasive medical techniques are intended to reduce the amount of tissue that is damaged during diagnostic or surgical procedures, thereby reducing patient recovery time, discomfort, and deleterious side effects. Teleoperated surgical systems that use robotic technology (so-called surgical robotic systems) may be used to overcome limitations of manual laparoscopic and open surgery. Advances in telepresence systems provide surgeons views inside a patient's body, an increased number of degrees of motion of surgical instruments, and the ability for surgical collaboration over long distances. Teleoperated control over surgical robotic technology typically involves user interaction with hand-controlled manipulators to control motion of surgical instruments and involves user interaction with finger-controlled selectors to trigger occurrence of robotic system events. Haptic feedback can improve a user's teleoperated control over surgical robotic technology.

SUMMARY

(2) In one aspect, a method is provided to control actuation of a click event by a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to a mount structure. Sensors sense amount of displacement distance of the hand-actuated selector from a neutral position. While the hand-actuated sensor is at a displacement distance less than a first threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a first control state to impart a maintaining force. While the hand-actuated sensor is at a displacement distance between a first threshold distance from the neutral position and a second threshold distance from the neutral position, motors are controlled according to a second control state to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that increases as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position. Once the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, a click event signal is imparted to cause an occurrence of the click event at a display system. Also, once the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, the one or more motors are controlled according to a third control state to reduce magnitude of the haptic force imparted to the hand-actuated selector to a reduced magnitude that is less than a maximum magnitude of the haptic force imparted during the second control state.

(3) In another aspect, a method is provided to control motion of a cursor in a first two-dimensional (2D) plane based upon motion of a user input device in a second 2D plane and based upon motion of a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to the user input device. The cursor is caused to move in the first 2D plane, to following motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a constant movement ratio, while the hand-actuated selector moves relative to the user input device at a rate less than a first threshold rate. The cursor is caused to move in the first 2D plane, to follow motion of the user interface device in the second 2D plane according to a movement ratio that decreases as a function of increasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device in response to rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the controller being between the first threshold rate and a second threshold rate. The cursor is caused to move in the first 2D plane, to follow motion of the user input device in the

second 2D plane according to motion ratio that increases as a function of decreasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device, in response to rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device decreasing below the second threshold rate.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) In the drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, like numerals may describe similar components in different views. Like numerals having different letter suffixes may represent different instances of similar components. Some embodiments are illustrated by way of example, and not limitation, in the figures of the accompanying drawings in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is an illustrative schematic drawing illustrating an example teleoperated surgical system.
- (3) FIG. 2A is an illustrative drawing illustrating an example user input control system, according to an embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 2B is an illustrative drawing illustrating an example instrument motion controller of an example user input control system.
- (5) FIG. 2C is an illustrative drawing illustrating an example armrest of an example user input control system.
- (6) FIG. 3 illustrates an example virtual surgical site viewable at a display system viewing plane during 3D mode operation.
- (7) FIGS. 4A-4D illustrate example graphical user interfaces viewable at a display system viewing plane during 2D mode operation.
- (8) FIG. 5 is an illustrative diagram showing an example viewing plane and an example haptic plane.
- (9) FIG. 6A is an illustrative perspective showing details of an example user input device that acts as a mount for a hand-actuated selector.
- (10) FIG. 6B is an illustrative functional block diagram showing a control system to control receive user input at a user input device that includes a hand-actuated selector and to impart haptic feedback at the user input device.
- (11) FIG. 7 is an illustrative drawing showing a first control function curve representing haptic force versus displacement of a displaceable hand-actuated selector position during a click event and also showing a time-aligned sequence of grip button displacements and a time-aligned with a sequence of hand formations.
- (12) FIG. 8 is an illustrative flow diagram representing a control process to control provision of haptic force and triggering of a click event based upon displacement of a hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device.
- (13) FIG. 9 is an illustrative diagram representing a configuration of the input controller to implement a first transform in absence of a click event.
- (14) FIG. 10 is an illustrative diagram representing a configuration of the controller the input controller to implement a second transform in presence of a click event.
- (15) FIG. 11 is an illustrative drawing showing a second control function curve representing an example second transform function to determine controller motion filtering versus time during a click event and also showing a time-aligned sequence of grip button displacements, a time-aligned with a sequence of hand formations, and a time-aligned sequence of viewing plane instances.
- (16) FIG. 12 is an illustrative block diagram of an example computer system.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

- (17) The following description is presented to enable any person skilled in the art to create and use systems and methods of a medical device simulator. Various modifications to the embodiments will

be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the generic principles defined herein may be applied to other embodiments and applications without departing from the scope of the inventive subject matter. Moreover, in the following description, numerous details are set forth for the purpose of explanation. However, one of ordinary skill in the art will realize that the inventive subject matter might be practiced without the use of these specific details. In other instances, well known machine components, processes and data structures are shown in block diagram form in order not to obscure the disclosure with unnecessary detail. Flow diagrams in drawings referenced below are used to represent processes. A computer system may be configured to perform some of these processes. Modules within flow diagrams representing computer-implemented processes represent the configuration of a computer system according to computer program code to perform the acts described with reference to these modules. Thus, the inventive subject matter is not intended to be limited to the embodiments shown but is to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and features disclosed herein.

(18) Teleoperated Surgical System

(19) FIG. 1 is a schematic drawing illustrating an example teleoperated surgical system **100**. The teleoperated surgical system **100** includes an instrument manipulator assembly **102** that may include one or more linkages, for manipulating operation of a surgical instrument **104** in response to user input control in performing various procedures on a patient **106**. The instrument manipulator assembly **102** is mounted to or located near an operating table **108**. A user input control system **110** allows a user **112** to view the surgical site and to control the instrument manipulator assembly **102**.

(20) In alternative embodiments, the example teleoperated surgical system **100** can include more than one instrument manipulator assembly **102**. The exact number of manipulator assemblies can depend on the surgical procedure and the space constraints within the operating room, among other factors.

(21) The user input control system **110** can be located in the same room as the operating table **108**. However, it should be understood that a user **112** such as a surgeon or clinician can be located in a different room or a completely different building from the patient **106**. The user input control system **110** generally includes a visions system that includes a visualization system **116** and a display system **120** and includes a motion system that includes or more user input devices **204**, one or more instrument manipulator assemblies **102** and an instrument motion and input device haptic feedback haptic controller (referred to herein as a “input controller”) **118**.

(22) The one or more user input devices **204** are operatively coupled to one or more instrument manipulator assemblies **102** for controlling motion of one or more instruments **104** in response to user input provided at the user input devices **204**. In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, the one or more user input devices **204** and the one or more instrument manipulator assemblies **102** are communicatively coupled to input controller **118**. An example motion controller processes user input received at the one or more user input devices **204** to control motion of the one or more instrument manipulator assemblies **102**. An example input controller **118** produces haptic feedback signals used to adjust the state of haptic forces at the one or more user input devices **204** based upon motion of the one or more instrument manipulator assemblies **102** and/or based upon motion of the user input devices **204**.

(23) The user input devices **204** may include any number of a variety of input devices, such as gravity-balanced arms, joysticks, trackballs, gloves, trigger-grips, twistable knobs, twistable grips, sliders, levers push buttons, or the like. In some embodiments, the user input devices **204** may be provided with the same degrees of freedom as the associated surgical instruments **104** to provide the user **112** with telepresence, or the perception that the user input devices **204** are integral with the instrument **104** so that the user **112** has a strong sense of directly controlling the instrument **104**. In some embodiments, the user input devices **204** is a manual input device that moves with six degrees of freedom or more, and which may also include an actuatable handle or other control

feature (e.g., one or more buttons, switches, etc.) for actuating instruments (for example, for closing grasping jaws, applying an electrical potential to an electrode, delivering a medicinal treatment, or the like).

(24) The visualization system **116** provides a concurrent two-dimensional (2D) or three-dimensional (3D) image of a surgical site to the user **112** as the user **112** operates one or more instruments. The visualization system **116** may include a viewing scope assembly such that visual images may be captured by an endoscope positioned within the surgical site. The visualization system **116** may be implemented as hardware, firmware, software or a combination thereof, which interact with or are otherwise executed by one or more computer processors, which may include processors of a control system **110**.

(25) A display system **120** may display a visual image of the surgical site and surgical instruments **104** captured by the visualization system **116**. The display system **120** and the user input devices **204** may be oriented such that the relative positions of the visual imaging device in the scope assembly and the surgical instruments **104** are similar to the relative positions of the surgeon's eyes and hands so the operator (e.g., user **112**) may manipulate the surgical instrument **104** with the user input devices **204** as if viewing a working volume adjacent to the instrument **104** in substantially true presence. By "true presence" it is meant that the presentation of an image is a true perspective image simulating the viewpoint of an operator that is physically manipulating the surgical instruments **104**.

(26) The instrument motion input controller **118** includes at least one processor circuit (not shown) and typically a plurality of processor circuits for effecting control between the user input devices **204**, the user input control system **110**, and the display system **120**. The input controller **118** also includes software programming instructions to implement some or all of the methods described herein. While the input controller **118** is shown as a single block in the simplified schematic of FIG. 1, the input controller **118** may comprise a number of data processing circuits (e.g., on the user input devices **204** and/or on the user input control system **110**). Any of a wide variety of centralized or distributed data processing architectures may be employed. Moreover, one or more processing circuits can be implemented at virtual machines. Similarly, the programming code may be implemented as a number of separate programs or subroutines or may be integrated into a number of other aspects of the teleoperated systems described herein. In various embodiments, the input controller **118** may support wireless communication protocols such as Bluetooth, IrDA, HomeRF, IEEE 802.11, DECT, and Wireless Telemetry.

(27) An example input controller **118** may include servo controllers to provide haptic force and/or haptic torque feedback at a user input device **204** based upon forces and torques sensed at a surgical instrument **104** to the user input devices **204**. An example input controller **118** may include servo controllers to provide haptic force and/or haptic torque feedback to a user input device **204** based upon forces and torques sensed at the input device the user input device **204**. Any suitable conventional or specialized servo controller may be used. A servo controller may be separate from, or integral with, the instrument manipulator assembly **102**. A servo controller also may be separate from, or integral with, the user input device **204**. In an example medical system, an example servo controller and a manipulator assembly **102** are provided as part of a robotic arm cart positioned adjacent to the patient **106**. In an example medical system, an example servo controller and a user input device **204** are positioned adjacent to a user providing input at the user input device **204**.

(28) For the purposes of this document, the surgical instrument **104** may be referred to as a "controlled device".

(29) In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, an input controller **118** controls at least one controlled device **104** (e.g., "surgical instrument") and may control movement of one or more linkages **102-1** of one or more instrument manipulator assemblies **102**. An example instrument manipulator assembly **102** includes one or more motors coupled to control motion of end effector associated with an instrument **104**. An example instrument manipulator assembly **102** includes one

or more motors coupled to control motion of one or more end effectors coupled to an instrument **104**. The linkages **102-1** may be referred to as a set-up structure, which includes one or more links coupled with joints **102-2** that allows the set-up structure to be positioned and held at a position and orientation in space. The motors coupled to control motion of one or more end effectors of an instrument are further coupled to the surgical instrument **104** so as to advance the surgical instrument **104** into a naturally or surgically created anatomical orifice and to move the surgical instrument **104** and to move an instrument's end effector in multiple degrees of freedom that may include three degrees of linear motion (e.g., x, y, and z linear motion) and three degrees of rotational motion (e.g., roll, pitch, yaw). The motors of an example manipulator assembly **102** may be configured to actuate an effector of the surgical instrument **104** such as an articulatable effector for grasping tissues in the jaws of a biopsy device or an effector for obtaining a tissue sample or for dispensing medicine, or another effector for providing other treatment as described more fully below, for example. U.S. Pat. No. 6,671,581, entitled, Camera Referenced Control in a Minimally Invasive Surgical Apparatus, which is incorporated by reference, contains further information on camera referenced control in a minimally invasive surgical apparatus.

(30) In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, for training purposes, the display system **120** may display a virtual environment simulating a surgical site within a patient. The virtual environment may include various biological structures in addition to the surgical instrument **104**. The user **112** operates a virtual instrument within the virtual environment to train, obtain certification, or experiment with various skills or procedures without having the possibility of harming a real patient.

(31) In either a live surgery or a simulated surgical procedure, the display system **120** may be used to present a user-interface to a user (e.g., the user **112**). In an embodiment, the display system **120** provides a 3D view, such as a stereo display. In another In an example teleoperated surgical system, the display system **120** is used to project a 3D image, such as from a high-definition endoscope camera. A user-interface may be displayed as an overlay, such as by using a translucent interface, or may be displayed in place of the view of the surgical field.

(32) FIG. 2A is a drawing illustrating an example user input control system **110**. A user may sit at the user input control system **110** and may access a display system **120**, and the user input devices **204**, and footswitch panel **206**. The footswitch panel **206** can act as a clutch, for example, that enables the user to switch between performing various tasks, such as swapping between various surgical instruments or controlling video or camera features. While seated at the user input control system **110**, the user may rest their arms on an armrest **208**. When operating in a live surgery, the display system **120** displays the surgical field as captured from a camera inserted through a small opening to the surgical site, sometimes referred to as a portal or a cannula. For training purposes, a simulated environment may be displayed on the display system **120**, where the simulated environment may be a stereoscopic display of a surgical site and virtual controlled devices (e.g., surgical instruments). As the user moves the user input devices **204**, a virtual surgical instrument may move in a corresponding fashion in the stereoscopic display.

(33) FIG. 2B is an illustrative drawing showing example user input devices **204** operatively coupled to the user input control system **110**. The example user input devices **204** include a gimbal mount **225**, which includes an articulated arm portion including a plurality of links **227** connected together by pivotal joints **229**. The user grips finger loops **210** by positioning his or her thumb and index finger over a displaceable hand-actuated selector **212**, such as a pincher push button, for example. In an example user input device **204**, a user's thumb and index finger are typically held on the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** by straps threaded through slots to create the finger loops **210**. The example selector **212** includes first and second grip buttons **503a**, **503b**, explained below with reference to FIG. 5, that are spaced apart at a distance so that they can be gripped between a user's thumb and index fingers with a user's thumb engaging one grip button and the user's index finger engaging the other, for example. At least one of the grip buttons is moveable to

reduce displacement distance between the grip buttons in response to a user squeezing force imparted to the grip buttons engaged between them. The joints **229** of the example user input device **204** are operatively connected to motors, or the like, to provide for, e.g., force feedback, gravity compensation, and the like. Furthermore, appropriately positioned sensors, e.g., encoders, or potentiometers, or the like, are positioned on each joint **229** of the example user input device **204**, so as to enable joint positions of the example user input device **204** to be determined by the user input controller **118** to control motion of one or more instruments operatively coupled to the user input devices or to control haptic feedback forces imparted to the one or more input devices **204**.

(34) An example teleoperated surgical system **100** includes two user input devices **204**, each with two finger loops **210** for which the user may insert an index finger and thumb of a respective hand. The two user input devices **204** may each control a surgical instrument or a virtual surgical instrument. The user may be provided software or hardware mechanisms to swap between multiple instruments for one or both instrument motion controller **204**. For example, a user may be provided three instruments, such as two forceps and a retractor. One or both of the forceps may be an energy instrument able to cauterize tissue. The user may first use the forceps at each instrument motion controller **204**, then switch the right example user input device **204** to control the retractor to expose a section of the surgical field, and then switch the right example user input device **204** back to the forceps to continue cutting, probing, or dissecting tissue.

(35) While using the example user input devices **204**, the user is provided with full 3D range of motion (x, y, and z axis) along with rotational motion (roll, pitch, yaw) in addition to pinching motion with the index and thumb (or any two fingers inserted into the loops **210**). As such, by moving the appropriate user input device **204**, the user is able to manipulate the corresponding surgical instrument through a full range of motion.

(36) FIG. 2C is a drawing illustrating an armrest **208** of a user input control system **110**, according to an embodiment. The armrest **208** may include one more touch control, such as touchscreens, soft buttons, mechanical buttons, or the like. In the example illustrated in FIG. 2C, a single touchscreen **214** is shown through which the user may configure various video, audio, or other system settings.

(37) Overview of Graphical User-Interface Control

(38) During operation, a user may be presented a user interface at various times. For example, a user interface may be presented to allow the user to choose from a selection of training modules. As another example, a user interface may be presented to allow the user to configure various aspects of the operation of the user input control system **110**. When the user has one or both hands operating an example user input device **204**, it may be inconvenient to have to release example user input device **204** and then operate another input mechanism, such as a touchscreen interface integrated into the armrest **208** of the user input control system **110**.

(39) FIG. 3 is an illustrative drawing showing a virtual surgical site displayed by the display system **120** operating in a 3D mode. The virtual surgical site **300** may be displayed on the display system **120** and includes two virtual controlled devices **302**. When operating in this mode, the user input devices **204** is able to move in 3D in free space (within the boundaries of the virtual surgical site **300**) to control the controlled devices **302**. In a second mode, the user input devices **204** are restricted to movement within a virtual surface that can be planar or have a contour such as a gentle curvature, for example. The second mode can be used, for example, to present a graphical user interface that includes control elements (e.g., buttons, knobs, sliders, pull-down menus) that can be controlled using the user input devices **204** as pointing and clicking devices, for example. The second mode can be used, for example, to present 2D images such as pre-operative images for example. The second mode is useful to provide an operating space for the user input devices **204** that can be roughly aligned with the 2D virtual surface.

(40) FIG. 4A illustrates a first example graphical user interface screen display **400** displayed by the display system **120** operating in a 2D mode. The first graphical user interface **400** is optionally

displayed as an overlay to the surgical site view or as a standalone interface. A cursor **402** is displayed within the first user interface **400** and is used to activate one or more user interface controls, such as buttons, sliders, option lists, etc. The cursor **402** may be controlled by a user input device **204**. Using servo controls coupled to the user input device **204**, the user may be provided with haptic feedback to provide a sensation of touching the first user interface **400**. For example, when the user uses an input device **204** to effect virtual motion of a user interface control structure, such to select a virtual button, slide a virtual slider control, or move a virtual dial displayed in the user interface, for example, the user input device **204** motors coupled to the input device **204** may cause the input device **204** to vibrate, shake, impart a reactive force to oppose the user's motion, or otherwise react to the actuation of the user interface control to provide the user with sensory feedback. FIG. **4A** illustrates an example login display **401**, which includes a user-selectable menu-pulldown arrow **404**. A user can move the cursor **402** to overlay the menu selection arrow **402**, whereupon the user can select the overlaid menu selection arrow **402** by actuating (e.g., by squeezing) the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212**, to impart a click event that causes occurrence of surgical system action such as display of a pulldown menu (not shown) in a display system **120** or energizing an electrosurgical instrument (not shown) within a surgical site **300**, for example.

(41) As used herein, a “click event” a click event may refer to a displacement of the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** that causes the controller **118** to send a signal to the display system to select or actuate a selectable element in a user interface display. As used herein, a “click event” also may refer to a displacement of the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** that causes the controller **118** to send a signal to one or more motors of the manipulator assembly to cause motion of one or more of a real or virtual instrument, instrument end effector, or manipulator lineage. In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, a click event causes selection or actuation of a selectable element in a user interface display during 2D operation of the system **100** and a click event causes motion of a real or virtual component of a manipulator assembly during 3D mode operation of the system **100**.

(42) For example, during 2D mode operation, a user can use the cursor to select a menu item from the pulldown menu. The login screen **401** also includes a keypad with multiple control elements (i.e. virtual buttons) **406**. A user can move the cursor **402** to overlay a keypad control element, whereupon the user can select the overlaid keypad button by squeezing the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212**, to impart a click event that causes display of the selected element in a display region **408**. In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, the keyboard control panel can be used to select an energy level electrosurgical instrument, for example.

(43) FIG. **4B** illustrates an example second graphical user interface screen display **421** that includes multiple control elements menu **420** and instrument manipulator assembly image **422** that shows an example instrument manipulator assembly **102**. In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, a user can use the user input device **204** in a 2D operation mode to select a control element from within the control elements menu **420**, whereupon a different menu (not shown) corresponding to the selected menu element is displayed.

(44) FIG. **4C** illustrates the example second graphical user interface screen display **421** of FIG. **4B** with an Endowrist Manipulation menu **425** displayed overlaying the instrument manipulator assembly image **422** in response to a user's selection of the Endowrist Manipulation control element of FIGS. **4B-4C**.

(45) FIG. **4D** illustrates the example second graphical user interface screen display **421** of FIGS. **4B-4C** with a Cursor Mode menu **427** displayed overlaying the instrument manipulator assembly image **422** in response to a user's selection of the Cursor Mode control element of FIGS. **4B-4D**. It is understood that more or fewer screens may be used in the second user interface **400**.

(46) The example first and second graphical user interface displays **400**, **402** are presented as a 2D interfaces. As such, when the user is controlling a cursor in the graphical user interface, the user

input devices **204** are constrained to a 2D region. In contrast, when in a surgical simulation mode (e.g., a first mode), the user input devices **204** are permitted full or nearly full 3D freedom of motion. However, in a graphical user interface mode (e.g., a second mode), the user input devices **204** are constrained to 2D motion. The 2D motion can be constrained to a planar region or to a region have a gentle curvature, such as a gentle convex curvature for example. A 2D region to which motion of the user input devices **204** are constrained can be oriented in space such that the user's hands and user input devices **204** are at approximately the same angle as that displayed in the display system **202**. Such correlation may assist the user to orient their hands in 3D space with respect to the graphical user interface displayed.

(47) An example is illustrated in FIG. 5, which shows a viewing plane **502** and a haptic plane **504**. The viewing plane **502** represents a planar region in which graphical user interface images are presented to a user by the user in the display system **202** in which the example first and second graphical user interface screen displays **400**, **421** of FIGS. 4A-4D can be displayed, for example. Cartesian coordinate locations in the viewing plane **502** correspond to cartesian coordinate locations in the haptic plane **504**. A user can select a control element displayed at a cartesian coordinate location in the viewing plane **502** by moving one of the user input devices **204** to a corresponding cartesian coordinate location in the haptic plane and clicking at that corresponding location. More particularly, motion of a cursor in the graphical user interface displayed in the viewing plane **502** follows motion of a user input device **204** in the haptic plane **504**. Thus, as a user causes a user input device **204** to move within the 2D haptic region **504**, a cursor is displayed moving correspondingly within one of the first and second graphical user interface screen displays **400**, **421** displayed within the visual image region **502**. In the second mode, user hand motion causes corresponding motion of a user input device **204** within the 2D region **504** that causes corresponding motion of a cursor image in the viewing region **502**. To select a desired control element displayed in the visual image region **502**, a user can engage a user input device **204** with his or her hand and move the hand to cause corresponding motion of the user input device **204** so as to cause corresponding motion of the cursor so as to visually align with the cursor with the desired control element. With the cursor aligned, the user then can select the desired control element, for example, by imparting a finger motion to impart motion to a displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** to affect a click-to-select (a 'click') user interface action. In response to the click, a processor circuit implements an action associated with the selected control element.

(48) The user input devices **204** are constrained within the 2D haptic planar region **504**. When a user attempts to move a user input device **204** "up" or "down" with respect to the z-axis of the haptic plane **504**, the user may encounter resistance from such movement. Should the user change the orientation of the viewing plane **502**, such as with a display configuration setting, then the haptic plane **504** may adjust to maintain an approximately parallel orientation with respect to the viewing plane **502**. In various embodiments, the haptic plane may be oriented at a fixed or dynamic angle offset with respect to viewing plane. Alternatively, the haptic plane may be oriented with a fixed or dynamic angle offset with respect to the ground. A user may also alter the constraints, for example, the position or orientation of the haptic plane.

(49) One or more processor circuits are configured to scale movement of a user input device **204** when imparting corresponding movement to a controlled device in the first (3D) mode and to impart corresponding movement to a cursor in the second (2D) mode. In the first mode, scaling allows a user to perform intricate medical procedures with greater ease than conventional open surgery. Scaling includes scaling a commanded movement of the user input device **204** according to a scale factor before imparting corresponding movement to a controlled device or to a cursor. Scaling considers changes in velocity and position of the user input device **204** and converts these to corresponding scaled changes in position of a controlled device or cursor. Scale factor is adjustable and can be different during operation in the first and second modes. In the second mode, for example, the scale factor can be unity (i.e. no scaling). U.S. Pat. No. 7,843,158, entitled

“Medical robotic System Adapted to Inhibit Motions Resulting in Excessive End Effector Forces, which is incorporated by reference, contains further information about scaling.

(50) User Input Device with Hand-Actuated Click Selector

(51) FIG. 6A is an illustrative perspective showing details of an example user input device **204** that acts as a mount for a displaceable hand-actuated click selector **212**. The example user input device **204** is mounted upon a gimbal mount assembly **225** and is coupled to the input controller **118** of FIG. 2A. The gimbal mount **225** includes a controller motion sensor (first sensor) **529** to sense motion of the overall controller **225**. An example user input device **204**, can include multiple controller motion sensors **529** (only one shown) to sense motion of the controller in multiple degrees of freedom. An example user input device **204** includes an example displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** that includes a pincher mount member configured as an elongated handle **530**, which includes a longitudinal axis **531**. The example displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** is formed integral with the example user input device **204**, such that the hand-actuated selector **212** moves in unison with 2D motion of the user input device **204** and such that the hand-actuated selector **212** moves in unison with 3D motion of the user input device **204**. The example hand-actuated selector **212** includes first and second articulable pincher grip buttons **530a**, **530b** mounted upon the handle **530**. The handle **530** acts as a mount member to mount the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** of the hand-actuated selector **212**. The first and second grip buttons **530a**, **530b** of the hand-actuated selector **212** upstand at an incline from opposite sides of the handle **530**.

(52) The first and second grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are secured to the handle **530** to articulate relative to the handle **530**. The first and second grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are inclined relative to the handle **530** with their distal ends spaced closer together and their proximal ends spaced farther apart. As used herein the term “proximal” indicates a location closer to a manipulator support structure and more distant from a patient anatomy, and the term “distal” indicates a location more distant from the manipulator support structure and closer to the patient. The first and second grip buttons **530a**, **530b** have an angle α between their distal ends that may vary according to forces exerted upon them by a user. In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, when a user exerts no pinching force to move the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** closer to one another, the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are in a neutral position. In an example user input device **204**, the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are maximally displaced from one another in the neutral position. In an example user input device **204**, when the grip members are in the neutral position, the angle α is an acute angle. In an example user input device **204**, in the neutral position, one or more motors **545** impart a haptic counter-force to the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** that resists a user-exerted force to move the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** toward one another, and a user must overcome this haptic counter-force to move the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** toward one another. In an alternative example user input device **204**, in the neutral position, a biasing member (not shown), such as a spring, provides a reactive force to resist displacement of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** toward one another, and a user must overcome this reactive force to move the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** toward one another.

(53) In an example user input device **204**, one or more motors **545** cause the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** to move to the neutral position on a first condition (i) when a user imparts no force to the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** and on a second condition (ii) when the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** have a displacement position distance between them that meets a prescribed threshold. In an alternative example user input device **204**, a biasing member (not shown), such as a spring, causes the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** to move to the neutral position on a first condition (i) when a user imparts no force to the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** and on a second condition (ii) when the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** have a displacement position distance between them that meets a prescribed threshold. In an example user input device **204**, the second condition occurs when the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** have a displacement position distance between them that is less than a second grip threshold (T.sub.G2) distance explained below. A click event causes a surgical system to launch an action such as a display action at the display system **120** or an instrument action within the surgical site **300** at or

before the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** reach a click event displacement position greater than the second grip threshold (T.sub.G2) distance. Thus, by the time the displacement distance position is in the first control state **776** of the graph **770** described below, an action has been launched in response to the decreased displacement distance between the grip buttons **530a**, **530b**. For example, a control element in the control elements menu **420** of the second graphical user interface screen display **421** of FIGS. **4B-4C** will have been selected and a screen display corresponding to the selected control element will be displayed. For example, if the click event is the selection of the Endowrist manipulation control element then the Endowrist Manipulation menu **425** of FIG. **4C** will be displayed.

(54) In an example user input device **204**, a user can impart force upon the respective grip buttons **530a**, **530b** in respective directions toward the handle **530** to reduce the displacement between them until the grip members abut the handle mount **530**, which acts as a stop surface, whereupon there is no displacement between the grip buttons and the handle mount. More specifically, in accordance with some embodiments, the first and second grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are secured to the handle to pivot about a master pivot axis **536**. One or more motors **545** or other biasing member urges the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** apart. In an example user input device **204**, one or more motors **545** are configured to impart a variable haptic force in a direction radially outward from the mount member **530** toward the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** during user-imparted radially inward direction motion of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** toward the handle **530**. In an example user input device **204**, the one or more motors **545** can include a single motor (not shown) that can impart haptic forces to both grip buttons **530a**, **530b**. In an alternative example user input device **204**, the one or more motors **545** can include a first motor (not shown) to impart haptic force to a first grip button **530a** and can include a second motor (not shown) to impart haptic force to the second grip button **530b**. The handle **530** includes one or more displacement sensors (a second sensor) **547** such as a Hall effect device to sense movement of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** along the first path and their displacement from the neutral displacement position. Finger loops (not shown) can be attached to the handle to avoid slipping from the grip buttons. A wide variety of grip button structures might be used within the scope of the disclosure, including any surgical instrument handles, optionally including rigid or flexible loops for the thumb and/or fingers, for example. Control relationships between the grip buttons and controlled devices is explained in more detail in U.S. Pat. No. 6,594,552, entitled, "Grip Strength with Tactile Feedback for Robotic Surgery", the full disclosure of which is expressly incorporated by this by reference.

(55) In the first (3D) operating mode, the user input device **204** and the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are operatively coupled through kinematics, for example, to control motion of a controlled device **104** in response to 3D motion of the user input device **204** and motion of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** about the master pivot axis **536**. In the second (2D) operating mode, the controller **204** and the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are operatively coupled to control 2D cursor movement within the viewing plane **502** and control element selection within the viewing plane **502**.

(56) In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, the one or more motors are selectably configured to impart to the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** a variable haptic force in a radially outward direction from the handle **530**. A user can use his or her fingers to impart forces to the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** to urge them toward the handle **530** located between them and toward one another so as to cause them to move closer together. As explained below, in the second (2D) mode, a user can use the hand-actuated selector **212** to effect a click event to select a graphical user interface control element, by imparting finger forces in a radially inward direction toward the handle **530** to overcome the neutral resistance and motor-controlled haptic force, and urge the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** toward one another. As explained below, a variable haptic force is imparted to the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** of the hand-actuated selector **212** to provide haptic feedback to indicate when an occurrence of a click event within the viewing plane **502** has occurred.

(57) An example user input device **204** includes a four-degree of freedom gimbal mount **225** to

allow a user to rotate of the actuatable mount member handle **530** about three axes, axis **534a**, axis **534b**, and axis **534c**. During operation in the first (3D) mode, a physical or virtual controlled device, such as an instrument **104**, follows 3D motion of the user input device **204**. During operation in the second (2D) mode, a controlled user interface element, such as a cursor, within the 2D viewing region **502** follows 2D motion of the user input device **204** within the 2D region **504**. (58) More particularly, the handle mount **530** portion of the user input device **204** is coupled to a first elbow-shaped link **514** by a first pivotal joint **16**. First link **532** is coupled to a second elbow-shaped link **537** by a pivotal joint **520**. Second link **537** is pivotally coupled to a third elbow-shaped link **538** by a pivotal joint **524**. In some embodiments, motors of arm **538** and gimbal **225** are capable of actively applying positional and orientational forces to mount member handle **530**, thereby providing tactile feedback to the surgeon. The gimbal **225** includes links **532**, **537**, **538**. Gimbal **225** is mounted to platform **540** so as to rotate about axis **534d**, and links **532**, **537**, **538** define additional axes **534a**, **534b** and **534c**. Handle **530** is mounted to gimbal **225** by an actively driven joint for motion about axis **534d**. Hence, gimbal **225** provides four driven orientational degrees of freedom, including a redundant orientational degree of freedom. Gimbal **225**, arm **538**, and the driving motors for these joints are described in more detail in U.S. Pat. No. 6,714,839, entitled "Master Having Redundant Degrees of Freedom", the full disclosure of which is expressly incorporated by this by reference.

(59) FIG. **6B** is an illustrative functional block diagram showing a control system **680** to control receive user input at a user input device **204** that includes a hand-actuated selector **212** and to impart haptic feedback at the user input device **204**. An input controller **118** is coupled to control the manipulator assembly **102** and is coupled to control the display system **120**. A user input device **204** is configured to receive first user input motion **652**, such as user hand motion, that imparts motion to the overall user input device **204**. A hand-actuated selector **212** is moveably mounted to the user input device **204** is configured to receive second user input **654**, such as user finger motion, that imparts motion to the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204**. One or more first sensors **547a** are configured to sense motion of the overall user input device **204** and to provide corresponding first sensor signals (S.sub.1) **549a** to the input controller **118**. One or more second sensors **547b** are configured to sense motion of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** and to provide corresponding second sensor signals (S.sub.2) **549b** to the input controller **118**. One or more motors **545** are coupled to receive motor control signals **551** from the input controller **118** and to impart haptic feedback forces **553** to the hand-actuated selector **212**. The input controller **118** is configured to provide motor control signals (Mc) **551** to one or more motors **545**, based upon one or more of the first and second sensor signals **549a**, **549b**, to cause the one or more motors to impart haptic feedback force (F.sub.H) **553** to the hand-actuated selector **212**.

(60) A user can provide a mode select signal (S.sub.M) **555** to cause the input controller **118** to operate in one of a 3D mode and a 2D mode. In the 3D mode, the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** can move in 3D in concert with motion of the user input device **204** in response to first user input motion **652** and can be displaced relative to the user input device **204** in response to second user input. In the 2D mode, the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** can move in 2D in concert with the user input device **204** in response to first user input and can be displaced relative to the user input device **204** in response to second user input motion **654**.

(61) In the 3D mode, the input controller **118** controls the manipulator assembly **102**, including one or more motors (not shown) controlling operation of one or more of an instrument **104**, an instrument end effector, and a manipulator link in response to motion imparting user input causing one or more of displacement of the overall user input device **204** and displaceable hand-actuated selector **612** relative to the user input device **204** on which the selector is mounted. In the 2D mode, the input controller **118** controls the display system **120**, including a graphical user interface screen display including one or more control elements such as, menu, cursor, slider, knob, or button, for

example, in response to user input causing one or more of displacement of the overall user input device **204** and displaceable hand-actuated selector **612** relative to the user input device **204**.

(62) The first displacement sensor **547a** is coupled to sense displacement of the overall user input device **204** and to provide the corresponding first sensor signals **549a** to the input controller **118** indicating displacement of the user input device **204**. A second sensor **547b** is coupled to sense displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** and to provide the corresponding second sensor signals **549b** to the input controller **118** indicating displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** on which the selector **212** is moveably mounted. The input controller **118** includes one or more processor circuits configured with executable instructions to provide control signals to control the manipulator assembly **102** in response to first and second sensor signals when in the 3D mode and to provide control signals to control the display system **120** in response to one or more of the first and second sensor signals when in the 2D mode. The input controller **118** is further configured to provide the motor control signals **553** to the one or more motors **545** to impart haptic feedback force $F_{sub.H}$ to the hand-actuated selector **212** in based upon one or more of the first and second sensor signals **549a**, **549b**.

(63) Haptic Feedback to Indicate Click Event

(64) FIG. 7 is an illustrative drawing showing a first control function curve **720** representing haptic force versus displacement of a displaceable hand-actuated selector **212** position during a click event that is time-aligned with a sequence of grip button displacements and with a sequence of hand formations. The example user input device **204** of FIG. 6A comprises a handle **530** that acts as a mount on which a pair of opposed grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are mounted. As explained above, alternative example hand actuated selectors include gravity-balanced arms, joysticks, trackballs, gloves, trigger-grips, twistable knobs, twistable grips, sliders, levers push buttons, or the like. A user can cause a click event by imparting a second user input motion that causes a prescribed displacement of the displaceable hand-actuated selector **212**. For the hand-actuated selector **212** of FIG. 6A, for example, example, a user can cause a click event by decreasing a displacement of distance of grip buttons **530a**, **530b** from a neutral position displacement to a click event completion position displacement distance. In the example user input device **204** of FIG. 6A, each grip button is equally displaced from the user input device's handle mount **530** throughout movement of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** between open and closed positions, although the displacement distance between the grip buttons decreases as the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** move from open to closed positions and increases as the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** move from closed to open positions. Moreover, in the example user input device **204** of FIG. 6A, each individual grip button **530a**, **530b** has a displacement distance between it and the user input device's handle mount **530** that decreases as that grip button moves from a neutral displacement position to a click event completion displacement position and that increases as that grip button moves from the click event displacement position to the neutral displacement position.

(65) FIG. 7 shows an example sequence of displacement positions of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** of the example hand-actuated selector **212** of FIG. 6A during a pincher closure due to a second user input motion **646** caused by a user's fingers during a click event is represented by the sequence of user finger positions **752**, **754**, **756**. FIG. 7 also shows a corresponding example sequence of displacement positions **762**, **764**, **768**, **770** of grip buttons **530a**, **530b** of the example hand-actuated selector **212** of FIG. 6A. For simplicity and clarity of illustration, an example user's fingers **758**, **760** and the sequence of finger positions **752**, **754**, **756** are shown separated from the respective grip buttons **530a**, **530b** that they contact and the corresponding sequence of grip button displacement positions **762**, **764**, **768**, **770**, although it will be understood that in actual use, respective fingers **758**, **760** are in contact with the respective grip buttons **530a**, **530b**. For example, in an actual example use, a cursor finger **758** contacts a first grip button **530a** and a thumb **760** contacts a second grip button **530b**.

(66) FIG. 7 shows an example sequence of displacement positions **762**, **764**, **768**, **770** of the grip

buttons **530a**, **530b** of FIG. **6A** that each corresponds to a different movement distance, relative to the user input device's handle **530**, travelled by the grip buttons during a click event. Thus, at an illustrative displacement distance indicated by grip button displacement position **762** and corresponding finger position **752**, the grip buttons have traveled the first (shortest) distance, relative to the user input device's handle **530**, in the illustrative sequence. At an illustrative displacement distance indicated by grip button displacement position **764** and corresponding finger position **754**, the grip buttons have traveled a second distance, relative to the user input device's handle **530**, that is greater than the first distance. At an illustrative displacement distance indicated by grip button displacement position **768** and corresponding finger position **756**, the grip buttons have traveled a third distance that is greater than the combined first and second distances, relative to the user input device's handle **530**. At an illustrative displacement distance indicated by grip button displacement position **770** and corresponding finger position **756**, the grip buttons have traveled a fourth distance relative to the user input device's handle **530**, that is greater than the first, second, and third distances.

(67) FIG. **7** also shows a corresponding sequence of finger positions of a hand **759** that imparts a second user input motion **654** to the grips **530a**, **530b**. The finger position sequence starts with fully open finger position **752**, followed by partially closed/partially open finger position **754**, which is followed by a substantially closed finger position **756**. A sequence of grip button displacement positions about a handle mount **530** is shown. The grip button sequence starts with fully open grip button displacement position **762**, followed by partially closed/partially open grip button displacement position **764**, followed by near-fully closed grip button displacement position **768**, followed by fully closed grip button position **770**.

(68) FIG. **7** includes an illustrative curve **770** representing a control function curve that controls a combined click event triggering and haptic feedback control function that is implemented using the hand-actuated selector **212**, the second sensor **547b**, the input controller **118**, the one or more motors **545**, and a stop surface such as an input device's handle **530**. The input controller **118** includes one or more processor circuits programmed with executable instructions to implement the control function **700**. The control function **770** controls triggering of a click event and controls haptic feedback force imparted in response to second user input motion **654** displacing the hand-actuated selector **212**. More particularly, the input controller **118** is configured to implement the control function in response to second sensor signals $S_{sub.2}$ provided by the one or more second sensors, to control triggering of a click event at the display system **120** or at the manipulator assembly **102** and to cause the one or more motors **545** to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector **212**. According to the control function **770**, to trigger a click event, a user must displace the hand-actuated selector **212** by at least a prescribed displacement distance. Moreover, according to the control function **770**, a haptic feedback force is imparted to the hand-actuated selector **212** while the user is displacing the hand-actuated selector **212**. The haptic feedback force indicates to the user, both a build up to and a triggering of a click event in response to the user's increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212**. The stop surface imparts an abrupt reactive force that stops further displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** after a prescribed amount of further displacement following triggering of a click event.

(69) The control function curve **770** has multiple states. A first control state **772** is a neutral or at rest state in which displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** is less than a first threshold displacement $T_{sub.D1}$. In the case of the user input device **204** of FIG. **6A**, in the first control state **772**, the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are displaced from the handle **530** by a distance that is between a maximal displacement in a neutral position and the first threshold distance $T_{sub.D1}$. In an example teleoperated surgical system **100**, in the first control state **772**, a resilient member imparts a maintaining force upon the hand-actuated selector **212** to urge it in the neutral displacement position. In the case of the user input device **204** of FIG. **6A**, in the first control state **772**, a biasing member, such as a spring member, urges the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** maximally displaced from

one another and from the handle **530**, while the input controller **118** causes the one or more motors to impart a constant, zero, force. In an alternative example teleoperated surgical system **100**, in the first control state, the input controller **118** causes the one or more motors **545** to impart a resilient maintaining force to the hand-actuated selector **212** to urge it to the neutral displacement position. In the alternative first control state **772**, the one or motors **545** are controlled to produce a spring-like maintaining force to maintain the hand-actuated selector **212** in the neutral displacement position. In the alternative first control state **772**, the one or motors provide a force to move the return the hand-actuated selector **212** to the neutral position in response to a user's imparting a force to overcome the maintaining force that causes the selector **212** to be displaced by less than first displacement threshold distance and the user's then removing that force. While in the first control state **772**, a user may impart motion to the hand-actuated selector to displace it somewhat from the neutral position provided that the displacement is the first threshold distance $T_{sub.D1}$. A magnitude and direction of such maintaining force in relation to a user's fingers for the example user input device of FIG. 6A is represented by arrows **752a**, **752b**. The first and second directions extend radially outward from the longitudinal axis **531** of the handle **530**.

(70) A second control state **774** is a haptic feedback force build-up state in which haptic force increases at a first rate relative to increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212**. The second control state **774** includes displacements of the hand-actuated selector **212** that meet the first threshold distance $T_{sub.D1}$ but do not yet meet a second threshold distance $T_{sub.D2}$. During the second control state **774**, the one or more second sensors **547b** sense increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** from the neutral position and send corresponding second sensor signal values $S_{sub.2}$ to the input controller **118** to report the increasing displacement. The input controller **118**, in turn, produces motor control signals **553** to cause the one or more motors **545** to impart haptic force the hand-actuated selector **212** that increases at a first rate relative to increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** from the neutral position. The first rate can be linear or non-linear provided that the rate is such that the user has time to recognize and react to the tactile sensation of increasing haptic force by following through with or aborting an imminent click event. In the case of the example user input device **204** of FIG. 6A, the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are displaced from one another by smaller and smaller amounts as they are increasingly displaced from their more widely spaced apart neutral positions. The build up of haptic force, which increases in magnitude at a first rate relative to increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** during the second control state **774**, provides a tactile indication, or warning, to a user of imminence of a click event: the greater the magnitude, the closer the current displacement is to causing an occurrence of a click event. The second rate is selected such that a user has time to react in response to an indication of imminence of a click event, so for example, the user can make a conscious decision to continue with the displacement and follow through with a click event or to stop the displacement and abort the click event. Thus, the increasing haptic feedback during the second control state **774** warns the user that a click event is increasingly imminent as the with increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212**.

(71) In the example user input device **204** of FIG. 6A, a magnitude of a second feedback force during the second control state is represented by the lengths of arrows **754a**, **754b**. Grip button **530a** imparts force **754a** in a first direction to index finger **758**, and grip button **530b** imparts force **754b** in a second direction opposite to the first direction to thumb **760**. The first and second directions extend radially outward from the longitudinal axis **531** of the handle **530** and from the longitudinal axis **531** of the handle **530**. It will be appreciated that in order to move the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** closer together during the second control state **774**, a user's fingers **758**, **760** impart respective displacement forces in directions opposite to the haptic force directions **754a**, **754b**. The user-imparted forces have magnitudes sufficiently large to overcome the haptic forces **754a**, **754b**. Also, it will be understood that magnitude of the haptic forces **754a**, **754b** imparted by the respective grip buttons **530a**, **530b** at any example instant in the second control state **774**, is greater

forces **752a**, **752b** during the maintaining force during the first control state **772**, as represented by the length of arrows **754a**, **754b** being greater than the length of the arrows **752a**, **752b**.

(72) A third control state **776** is a click event trigger state that occurs when displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** meets the second threshold distance $T_{sub.D2}$. The second sensors **547b** send to the input controller **118** second sensor signals indicating when the displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212** reaches the second threshold displacement $T_{sub.D2}$ from the neutral position.

(73) An example input controller **118**, when operating in a 2D mode, in response to the hand-actuated sensor **212** reaching the second threshold displacement $T_{sub.D2}$, sends a click event triggering signal to the display system **120** causing selection of a visual UI control element overlaid by a cursor **402** in the control elements menu **420**, for example. An example input controller **118**, when operating in a 3D mode, in response to the hand-actuated sensor **212** reaching the second threshold displacement $T_{sub.D2}$, sends a click event triggering signal to the manipulator assembly **102** causing actuation of one or more motors (not shown) to actuate a link or an instrument end effector, for example.

(74) Additionally, an example input controller **118**, when operating in either a 2D mode or a 3D mode, in response to the hand-actuated sensor **212** reaching the second threshold displacement $T_{sub.D2}$, imparts a motor control signal M_c on line **551** causing the one or more motors **545** to impart a step-down haptic feedback force to the hand-actuated selector **212**. The step-down haptic feedback force decreases haptic feedback force from a peak value at the moment when displacement of the to the hand-actuated selector **212** crosses the second threshold displacement $T_{sub.D2}$, to a level that matches or approximately matches a force imparted during the first control state **772**. More particularly, the haptic force decreases at a second rate relative to increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector **212**. The magnitude of the second rate is greater than a magnitude of the first rate. In an example system, the second rate has a magnitude selected to provide a user with a substantially instantaneous tactile indication that a click event has been triggered. In the example user input device **204** of FIG. **6A**, a magnitude of a third feedback force during the third control state **776** is represented by the lengths of arrows **756a**, **756b**. Grip button **530a** imparts force **764a** in a first direction to index finger **758**, and grip button **530b** imparts force **756b** in a second direction opposite to the first direction to thumb **760**. In an example system, the control function returns to the first control state **772** in response to the one or more sensors **247b** providing signals to indicate when the displacement returns to the neutral displacement distance, the third control state **776**.

(75) In an example user input device **204**, the selector **212** impacts a stop surface at or about the moment that the hand-actuated selector **212** reaches the third threshold displacement $T_{sub.D3}$ at control stage **778**. In the example input device **204** of FIG. **6A**, the hand-actuated selector **212** includes the displaceable grip buttons **530a**, **530b** and the handle **530** acts as a stop surface. The impact of the hand-actuated selector **212** upon the stop surface provides an abrupt reactive force that provides an additional tactile sensation to a user indicating that the click event is complete and that the hand-actuated selector **212** is ready to return to the second control state **772**, which is the rest or neutral state. Thus, the stop surface **530**, provides haptic feedback when the control function **700** has in effect, returned to the first control state **772** in which the one or more motors **545** provide a maintaining force.

(76) FIG. **8** is an illustrative flow diagram representing a control process **800** according to the control function of FIG. **7** to control provision of force and triggering of a click event based upon displacement of a hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204**. The input controller **118** includes one or more processor circuits programmed with executable instructions to implement the control process **800**. At operation **802** during the first control state **772**, the input controller **118** causes the one or more motors **545** to provide a neutral maintaining force ($F_{sub.HN}$) to the hand-actuated selector **212** while the one or more second sensors **547b** indicate that a user

has provided no second user input motion **654** causing the hand-actuated selector **212** to be displaced by at least a first threshold distance $T_{sub.D1}$ from a neutral position. A first threshold decision operation **804** monitors the one or more second sensors **547b** to detect when the displacement of the hand-actuated selector meets the first threshold displacement $T_{sub.D1}$. In the example hand-actuated selector **212** of FIG. 6A, the first threshold decision operation **804** determines when displacement position of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** from their neutral position meets the first displacement threshold. An example input controller **118** provides a motor control signal causing the one or more motors **545** to produce zero magnitude haptic force while the selector **212** is displaced by less than the first threshold haptic distance; a biasing member such as a spring maintains the selector **212** in the neutral position while the selector **212** is displaced by less than the first threshold haptic distance.

(77) The control process transitions to the second control state **774** in response to the displacement meeting the first threshold displacement distance $T_{sub.D1}$. The process **800** remains in the first control state **772** while displacement does not yet meet the first threshold displacement distance. At operation **806** during the second control state **774** the input controller **118** causes the one or more motors **545** to impart a haptic feedback force to the hand-actuated selector **212** that increases at a first rate that is a function of increasing displacement of the grip buttons from the neutral position. In an example system, operation **806** can set a rate of buildup of haptic feedback force to vary as a linear or non-linear function of displacement, for example. A second threshold decision operation **808** monitors the one or more second sensors **547b** to detect when the displacement of the hand-actuated selector meets the second threshold displacement $T_{sub.D2}$. In the example hand-actuated selector **212** of FIG. 6A, the second threshold decision operation **808** determines when displacement position of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** from their neutral position meets the second displacement threshold distance.

(78) The control process transitions to a third control state **776** in response to the displacement meeting the second threshold displacement distance $T_{sub.D2}$. The process **800** remains in the second control state **774** while displacement does not yet meet the second threshold displacement distance. At operation **809**, the input controller **118** sends a control signal to the display system **120** to trigger an occurrence of a click event. At operation **810**, during the third control state **776** the input controller **118** causes the one or more motors **545** to impart a haptic feedback force to the hand-actuated selector **212** that decreases at a second rate from a peak value when transiting from the second to the third control state to a level that matches or approximately matches a force imparted during the first control state **772**. The magnitude of the second rate is greater than a magnitude of the first rate. During decision operation **812**, the input controller **118** monitors sensor signals provided by the one or more sensors **547b** to determine when the displacement of the selector **212** meets (e.g., less than or equal to) the first threshold displacement $T_{sub.D1}$. In response to the displacement meeting the first displacement distance, control process **800** transitions back to operation **802**.

(79) Variation in haptic force during the first, second and third control states provides a user with tactile indications of the status of a click event. During the second control state **774**, the buildup of haptic force indicates to a user that a trigger event is increasingly imminent. During the third control state **776**, a swift decrease in haptic force indicates the triggering of a click event. During the first control state **772**, a maintaining force maintains the hand-held reinforces to a user that the haptic event has occurred. A hard stop at a physical stop surface **530** indicates to a user return that the hand-actuated selector **212** has returned to the neutral first control state **772**.

(80) Isolating Cursor Motion from Push Button Motion

(81) During operation of the display system **120** in the second (2D) mode, digits of a user's hand can be used to select a control element displayed in the viewing plane **502**. During operation second mode, the input controller **118** causes motion of a cursor **402** in the graphical user interface displayed in the viewing plane **502** to follow motion of a user input device **204** in the haptic plane

504. Cartesian coordinate locations in the viewing plane 502 correspond to cartesian coordinate locations in the haptic plane 504. A user selects a control element, by first, moving user input device 204 to a coordinate location in the haptic plane 504 that corresponds to a control element coordinate location in the viewing plane 502 to visually align the cursor 402 with the control element, and by second, imparting an actuation motion to the hand-actuated selector 212. A user's fingers can impart motion to a hand-actuated selector 212 to increase its displacement from a neutral position to trigger a click event as described above with reference to FIGS. 7-8, for example.

(82) Motion of a user's fingers can influence motion of the rest of a user's hand. Referring to the example hand-actuated selector 212 of FIG. 6A, when a user imparts a closure force to the grip buttons 530a, 530b to implement a click, the user's finger motion can cause a corresponding motion of the controller 204 on which the grip buttons 530a, 530b are mounted. A user-imparted motion of the grip buttons 530a, 530b can result in a slight unintended change, or jump, in position of the controller 204. Such unintended change in position of the controller 204 in the haptic plane 504 can cause a corresponding unintended change in position of the cursor 402 in the viewing pane 502. As a result, when the grip buttons 530a, 530b are used for clicking on a control element in a graphical user interface menu, for example, the cursor 402 can tend to jump over the control element during the clicking process. Thus, a user's sudden actuating a click event can cause a sudden unintended jump in cursor movement resulting in misalignment of cursor with a target control element, which can result in selection of an erroneous target. This can be particularly frustrating if a targeted clickable control element is not large and the user ends up missing the targeted element.

(83) A missed target can be especially deleterious in a surgical environment. For example, the viewing plane 502 can display a pre-operative MRI or CT scan instead of or in addition to control elements. A target element with which a surgeon user intends to visually align the cursor for selection may be a delicate anatomical feature, such as a nerve or a blood vessel, for example. The surgeon may intend to enlarge the view of the feature or to transition to other anatomical features represented in the MRI or CT scan that are located above or below the targeted feature. Thus, precision alignment between cursor and target element may be required.

(84) Referring again to the control system of FIG. 6B, an example input controller 118 is configured to compute a motion transform function to provide to the display system 120 on line 561, a cursor motion control signal that indicates motion of the user input device 204 sensed by the one or more first sensors 547a. the first cursor motion input signal and the second cursor motion input signal. The display system displays motion of the cursor 402 within the graphical user interface 400 that follows motion of the user input device 204.

(85) In an example user input device 204, a click event typically involves rapid movement of a hand-actuated selector 212. The controller system 118 is configured with instructions to adjust transform functionality during an occurrence of user motion input to a hand-actuated selector 212 that is mounted to the user input device 204 to effect a click event where such user motion input also could influence motion of the user input device. FIG. 9 is an illustrative diagram representing a configuration of the input controller 118 to implement a first transform F1 in absence of a click event. FIG. 10 is an illustrative diagram representing a configuration of the controller the input controller 118 to implement a second transform F2 in presence of a click event.

(86) Referring to FIG. 9, based on the input controller 118 determining that motion of a user's digits (e.g., fingers and/or thumbs) and/or overall hand motion indicates that the user is not in the process of causing a launch of a click event signal, the input controller 118 imparts a first transform function F1 that causes motion of a cursor 402 in the viewing plane 502 to follow motion of a user input device 204 in the haptic plane 504. More particularly, an example input controller 118 is configured to cause cartesian coordinates of the cursor 402 in the viewing plane 502 to match cartesian coordinates of the user input device 204 in the haptic plane 504. Moreover, in the absence of a click event, an example input controller 118 can scale motion of the user input device 204 to

motion of the cursor **402** by a prescribed amount. For example, an input controller **118** can be calibrated for a predetermined one-to-one (1:1) movement ratio of user input device motion to cursor motion in which, distance that the user input device **204** moves in the haptic plane **504** exactly matches distance by which the cursor **402** moves in the viewing plane **502**. Alternatively, for example, the input controller **118** can be calibrated for a predetermined two-to-one (2:1) movement ratio in which, distance that the user input device **204** moves in the haptic plane **504** exactly twice distance by which the cursor **402** moves in the viewing plane **502**.

(87) Referring to FIG. **10**, based on the input controller **118** determining that motion of a user's digits (e.g., fingers and/or thumbs) and/or overall hand motion indicates that the user is in the process of causing a launch a click event, the input controller **118** imparts a second transform function **F2** that reduces the ratio of cursor movement in response to user input device movement during a time interval when a user is causing a launch of a click event. The reduced movement ratio results in reduction in cursor motion in the viewing plane **502** during a click in response to user input device motion in the haptic plane **504**.

(88) FIG. **11** is an illustrative drawing showing a second control function curve **820** representing an example second transform function **F2** to determine controller motion filtering versus time during a click event and also showing a time-aligned sequence of grip button displacements, a time-aligned with a sequence of hand formations, and a time-aligned sequence of viewing plane instances. As used herein, selector velocity refers to rate of increase in displacement from a neutral position of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to a base of a user input device **204**. In the example case of FIG. **6A**, selector velocity refers to rate of increase in displacement of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** relative to the handle **530**. As used herein, an increase in controller motion filtering corresponds to a decrease in a ratio of movement of motion of a user input device **204** to motion of a cursor **402**. That is, the greater the magnitude controller motion filtering the less a movement of the input device **204** in the haptic plane **504** causes a corresponding movement of the cursor **402** in the viewing plane **502**.

(89) The example second transform function **F2** includes first, second, and third filtering functions. As depicted by the second control function curve **820**, the input controller **118** is configured to impart a first filtering function **822** that spans a first time interval, $T_{sub.1}$, during which displacement of a hand-actuated selector **212** from a neutral position relative to the user input device **204** changes at a rate that is less than a first threshold displacement rate ($T_{sub.R1}$). As depicted by the second control function curve **820**, the input controller **118** is configured to impart a second filtering function **824** that spans a second time interval $T_{sub.2}$ during which displacement of a hand-actuated selector **212** from a neutral position relative to the user input device **204** changes at a rate that is equal to or greater than the first threshold rate $T_{sub.R1}$. As depicted by the second control function curve **820**, the input controller **118** is configured to impart a third filtering function **826** spans a third time interval $T_{sub.3}$, following the second time interval $T_{sub.2}$, when grip buttons **530a**, **530b** continue to move but at a rate that is no longer equal to or greater than the first threshold rate $T_{sub.R1}$. In the case of the example selector **212** of FIG. **6A**, displacement of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** from their neutral positions relative to the handle **530** increases during each of the first, second, and third time intervals.

(90) Referring to the second control function curve **820**, during the first time interval $T_{sub.1}$, while the hand-actuated selector **212** move relative to the user input device **204** (e.g., grip buttons **530a**, **530b** move relative to handle **530**) at a rate less than a $T_{sub.R1}$, the first filtering function **822** increases user input device motion filtering in correspondence with increasing rate of input device motion; the faster the hand-actuated selector **212** moves relative to the input device **204** (e.g., the faster the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** move relative to the handle **530**), the less a movement of the user input device **204** effects a corresponding movement of the cursor **402**. which corresponds to a reducing of the movement ratio with increasing rate of grip button movement. Thus, motion of the cursor **402** follows motion of the user input device **204** according to a first dynamic movement

ratio during the first time interval T.sub.1. Referring to the example of FIG. 6A and to FIG. 11, direction of arrows **852a**, **852b** indicates lessening of displacement distance between the fingers **758**, **760** and between grip buttons **530a**, **530b**. The length of the arrows **852a**, **852b** indicate rate at which the grip buttons are moving closer together. An example input controller **118** can be configured to use the first filtering function **822** to increase user input device motion filtering (which correspondingly decreases the movement ratio) as a linear function of time, a logarithmic function of time or an exponential function of time, for example. Thus, during the first time interval T.sub.1, while the selector displacement rate is less than the first threshold rate T.sub.R1, filtering of user input device motion increases with increasing selector rate.

(91) During the second time interval T.sub.2, while hand-actuated selector **212** moves relative to the selector at a rate equal than or greater than the first threshold rate T.sub.R1, the second filtering function **822** causes a substantially constant minimal movement ratio. In an alternative example surgical system **100**, while hand-actuated selector **212** moves relative to the selector at a rate equal than or greater than the first threshold rate T.sub.R1, the second filtering function **822** causes motion of the cursor **402** to stop such that the cursor motion does not follow motion of the user input device **204**. Referring to the example of FIG. 6A and to FIG. 11, direction of arrows **854a**, **854b** indicates lessening of displacement distance between the fingers **758**, **760** and between grip buttons **530a**, **530b**. Since the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** are moving at a faster rate during the second time interval T2 than during the first time interval, arrows **854a**, **854b** have greater length than arrows **852a**, **852b**. An example input controller **118** can be configured to cause the movement ratio to be zero during the second time interval. That is, the cursor **402** does not move in response to movement of the controller **204**. More particularly, for example, an example input controller **118** can be configured to cause cursor motion to stop during the second time interval T.sub.2, (i.e. transition to a movement ratio 1:0). Alternatively, for example, an example input controller **118** can be configured to cause a movement ratio decrease to 1:0.1 during the second time interval T.sub.2. Thus, during the second time interval T.sub.2, the filtering of user input device motion and the corresponding movement ratio remain constant while the rate of movement of the grip buttons **530a**, **530b** is at or exceeds T.sub.R1. A duration of the second time interval T.sub.2 is determined based upon length of time that the rate of movement of the selector **212** **530a**, **530b** matches or exceeds the first threshold rate T.sub.R1.

(92) In an example surgical system **100**, a click event **809** is triggered during the second time interval T2. The triggering of a click event can be controlled according to the first control function curve **720** of FIG. 7 and the control process **800** of FIG. 8, for example.

(93) During the third time interval T.sub.3, when rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector **212** decreases to a rate less than a T.sub.R1, the third filtering function **826** causes decrease in controller motion filtering as a function of time, which corresponds to an increase of the movement ratio as a function of time. Thus, motion of the cursor **402** follows motion of the user input device **204** according to a second dynamic movement ratio during the third time interval T.sub.3.

Referring to the example hand actuated selector **212** and user input device **204** of FIG. 6A, since the rate of movement of grip buttons **530a**, **530b** relative to handle **530** is greater during the second time interval T.sub.2 than during the third time interval T.sub.3, arrows **856a**, **856b** have shorter length than arrows **854a**, **854b**. An example input controller **118** can be configured to use the third filtering function **826** to decrease controller motion filtering (which correspondingly increases the movement ratio) as a linear function of time, a logarithmic function of time or an exponential function of time, for example. Moreover, an example input controller **118** can be configured to use the third filtering function **826** to cause the movement ratio to increase as a function of time until it regains a pre-click movement ratio of 1:1, for example. Thus, during the third time interval T.sub.3, the filtering of user input device motion decreases with time, which means that the movement ratio increases with time.

(94) Still referring to FIG. 11, the sequence of viewing window display instances **502a**, **502b**, **502c**,

502d pictorially represent changes in in cursor rate of movement within the viewing plane **502** at different points along the second control function curve **820**. In each sequential viewing window instances **502a**, **502b**, **502c**, **502d**, a respective arrow **503a**, **503b**, **503d** is associated with the cursor **402**. A length of the respective arrow in each respective viewing window display instance represents a magnitude of the movement ratio, the ratio of user input device motion to corresponding cursor motion, during the display time of respective viewing window.

(95) Before start of an example click event, the movement ratio filter function to impart a maximum value movement ratio represented by long length of the respective arrow **503a** in respective viewing window display **502a**.

(96) During the first time interval T.sub.1, in response to movement of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** at a rate less than a T.sub.R1, the example input controller **118** is configured by the second transform function F2 to increase in user input device motion filtering as a function of rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204**, which corresponds to a reducing of the movement ratio with increasing rate of decrease of grip button displacement. The reduction in movement ratio is represented by the shorter length of arrow **503b** in the viewing window display **502b**.

(97) During the second time interval T.sub.2, in response to the hand-actuated selector **212** moving relative to the user input device **204** at a rate equal to or greater than T.sub.R1, the input controller **118** is configured by the second transform function F2 to cause a constant minimal movement ratio despite a continued increase in the rate of movement. The minimal movement ratio is represented by the absence of an arrow in the viewing window display **502c**.

(98) During the third time interval T.sub.3, in response to movement of the hand-actuated selector **212** relative to the user input device **204** at a decreased rate that no longer is equal to or greater than T.sub.R1, the input controller **118** is configured by the second transform function F2 to cause a decrease in controller motion filtering (which correspondingly increases the movement ratio) as a function of time. The increase in movement ratio is represented by the reappearance and of arrow **503d** in the viewing window display **502d**. It is noted that the shorter length of the arrow **503d** indicates that the movement ratio has not yet returned to the pre-click level.

(99) Computer Hardware and Storage Devices

(100) FIG. **12** is an illustrative block diagram showing an example machine upon which any one or more of the techniques (e.g., methodologies) discussed herein may perform, according to an example embodiment. FIG. **12** shows an illustrative diagrammatic representation of a more particularized computer system **1200**, which can be used to implement the controller system **118**, for example. The computer system **1200** can be configured to implement, for example, a computerized training module. In alternative embodiments, the computer system **1200** operates as a standalone device or may be connected (e.g., networked) to other machines. In a networked deployment, the computer system **1200** may operate in the capacity of a server or a client machine in server-client network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment. The computer system **1200** may be a server computer, a client computer, a personal computer (PC), a tablet PC, a Personal Digital Assistant (PDA), a cellular telephone, or any machine capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine. Further, while only a single machine (i.e., computer system **1200**) is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include any collection of machines that individually or jointly execute a set (or multiple sets) of instructions to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

(101) The example computer system **1200** includes a processor **1202** (e.g., a central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), or both), a main memory **1204** and a static memory **1206**, which communicate with each other via a bus **1208**. The computer system **1200** may further include a video display unit **1210** (e.g., liquid crystal display (LCD), organic light emitting diode (OLED) display, touch screen, or a cathode ray tube (CRT)) that can be used to display positions of

the surgical instrument **124** and flexible instrument **120**, for example. The computer system **1200** also includes an alphanumeric input device **1212** (e.g., a keyboard, a physical keyboard, a virtual keyboard using software), a cursor control device or input sensor **1214** (e.g., a mouse, a track pad, a trackball, a sensor or reader, a machine readable information reader, bar code reader), a disk drive unit **1216**, a signal generation device **1218** (e.g., a speaker) and a network interface device or transceiver **1220**.

(102) The disk drive unit **1216** includes a non-transitory machine-readable storage device medium **1222** on which is stored one or more sets of instructions **1224** (e.g., software) embodying any one or more of the methodologies or functions described herein. The instructions **1224** may also reside, completely or at least partially, within the main memory **1204**, static memory **1206** and/or within the processor **1202** during execution thereof by the computer system **1200**, the main memory **1204** and the processor **1202** also constituting non-transitory machine-readable storage device media. The non-transitory machine-readable storage device medium **1222** also can store an integrated circuit design and waveform structures. The instructions **1224** may further be transmitted or received over a network **1226** via the network interface device or transceiver **1220**. While the machine-readable storage device medium **1222** is shown in an example embodiment to be a single medium, the term “machine-readable medium,” “computer readable medium,” and the like should be taken to include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, and/or associated caches and servers) that store the one or more sets of instructions **1224**. The term “machine-readable medium” shall also be taken to include any medium that is capable of storing, encoding or carrying a set of instructions for execution by the machine and that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies of the present disclosure. The term “machine-readable medium” shall accordingly be taken to include, but not be limited to, solid-state memories, optical and magnetic media, and carrier wave signals

(103) It will be appreciated that, for clarity purposes, the above description may describe some embodiments with reference to different functional units or processors. However, it will be apparent that any suitable distribution of functionality between different functional units, processors or domains may be used without detracting from the present disclosure. For example, functionality illustrated to be performed by separate processors or controllers may be performed by the same processor or controller. Hence, references to specific functional units are only to be seen as references to suitable means for providing the described functionality, rather than indicative of a strict logical or physical structure or organization.

(104) Although the present disclosure has been described in connection with some embodiments, it is not intended to be limited to the specific form set forth herein. One skilled in the art would recognize that various features of the described embodiments may be combined in accordance with the present disclosure. Moreover, it will be appreciated that various modifications and alterations may be made by those skilled in the art without departing from the scope of the present disclosure.

(105) In addition, in the foregoing detailed description, it can be seen that various features are grouped together in a single embodiment for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the claimed embodiments require more features than are expressly recited in each claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, inventive subject matter lies in less than all features of a single disclosed embodiment. Thus the following claims are hereby incorporated into the detailed description, with each claim standing on its own as a separate embodiment.

(106) The foregoing description and drawings of embodiments in accordance with the present invention are merely illustrative of the principles of the inventive subject matter. Therefore, it will be understood that various modifications can be made to the embodiments by those skilled in the art without departing from the scope of the inventive subject matter, which is defined in the appended claims.

(107) Thus, while certain exemplary embodiments of the invention have been described and shown

in the accompanying drawings, it is to be understood that such embodiments are merely illustrative of and not restrictive on the broad inventive subject matter, and that the embodiments of the invention not be limited to the specific constructions and arrangements shown and described, since various other modifications may occur to those ordinarily skilled in the art.

Various Examples

(108) Example 1 can include a method to control actuation of a click event by a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to a mount structure, comprising: using one or more sensors to sense amount of displacement distance of the hand-actuated selector from a neutral position; in response to the hand-actuated sensor at a displacement distance less than a first threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a first control state to impart a maintaining force; in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor at a displacement distance between a first threshold distance from the neutral position and a second threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a second control state to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that increases as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position; in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, imparting a click event signal to cause an occurrence of the click event at a display system, and controlling the one or more motors according to a third control state to reduce magnitude of the haptic force imparted to the hand-actuated selector to a reduced magnitude that is less than a maximum magnitude of the haptic force imparted during the second control state.

(109) Example 2 can include the subject matter of Example 1, wherein the maintaining force is zero.

(110) Example 3 can include the subject matter of Example 1, wherein the maintaining force is less than a haptic force imparted by the one or more motors according to the second control state.

(111) Example 4 can include the subject matter of Example 1, wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases in magnitude to the reduced magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position.

(112) Example 5 can include the subject matter of Example 4, wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the second control state includes controlling the one or more motors to increase magnitude of the haptic force at a first rate; and wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to decrease magnitude of the haptic force at a second rate; and wherein a magnitude of the first rate is less than a magnitude of the second rate.

(113) Example 6 can include the subject matter of Example 4, wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases in magnitude to the reduced magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position.

(114) Example 7 can include the subject matter of Example 4 wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases instantaneously to the reduced magnitude.

(115) Example 8 can include the subject matter of Example 1 further including: using the one or more motors to cause the hand-actuated selector to move to the neutral position.

(116) Example 9 can include the subject matter of Example 1, further including: using a resilient member to cause the hand-actuated selector to move to the neutral position.

(117) Example 10 can include the subject matter of Example 1, further including: using a stop surface to stop motion of the hand-actuated selector.

(118) Example 11 can include the subject matter of Example 1, further including: using a stop

surface at the mount structure to stop motion of the hand-actuated selector.

(119) Example 12 can include the subject matter of Example 1, further including: using a stop surface, positioned to impart a reactive force to the hand-actuated selector to stop further displacement of the hand-actuated selector when the hand-actuated selector reaches the third threshold displacement distance from the neutral position.

(120) Example 13 can include the subject matter of Example 1, further including: controlling the one or more motors according to a third control state to impart the reduced magnitude to the hand-actuated selector at displacement distances between a displacement distance at which the reduced magnitude is first imparted to the hand-actuated selector and the third threshold distance.

(121) Example 14 can include the subject matter of Example 1, wherein the one or more sensors are configured to sense displacement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the mount structure.

(122) Example 15 can include the subject matter of Example 1, wherein using the one or more sensors to sense amount of displacement of the hand-actuated selector from a neutral position during movement of the hand-actuated selector.

(123) Example 16 can include an apparatus to control actuation of a click event by a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to a mount structure, comprising: one or more sensors configured to sense position of the hand-actuated selector; one or more motors configured to impart haptic force to the hand-actuated selector; processing circuitry; and a memory system storing instructions which, when executed by the processing circuitry, cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: using the one or more sensors to sense amount of displacement of the hand-actuated selector from a neutral position; in response to the hand-actuated sensor at a displacement distance less than a first threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a first control state to impart a maintaining force; in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor at a displacement distance between the first threshold distance from a neutral position neutral position and a second threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a second control state to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that increases in magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position; in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, imparting a click event signal to cause an occurrence of the click event at a display system, and controlling the one or more motors according to a third control state to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases in magnitude to a reduced magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position, the reduced magnitude being less than a maximum magnitude of the haptic force imparted during the second control state; and controlling the one or more motors according to a third control state to a reduce magnitude of the haptic force imparted to the hand-actuated selector to a reduced magnitude that is less than a maximum magnitude of the haptic force imparted during the second control state.

(124) Example 17 can include the subject matter of Example 16, wherein the maintaining force is zero.

(125) Example 18 can include the subject matter of Example 16, wherein the maintaining force is less than a haptic force imparted by the one or more motors according to the second control state.

(126) Example 19 can include the subject matter of Example 16, wherein the act of controlling the control the one or more motors according to the third control state occurs after the act of imparting the click event signal.

(127) Example 20 can include the subject matter of Example 16, wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases in magnitude to the reduced magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position.

(128) Example 21 can include the subject matter of Example 20, wherein controlling the one or

more motors according to the second control state includes controlling the one or more motors to increase magnitude of the haptic force at a first rate; and wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to decrease magnitude of the haptic force at a second rate; and wherein a magnitude of the first rate is less than a magnitude of the second rate.

(129) Example 22 can include the subject matter of Example 20, wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases in magnitude to the reduced magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position.

(130) Example 23 can include the subject matter of Example 20, wherein controlling the one or more motors according to the third control state includes controlling the one or more motors to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that decreases instantaneously to the reduced magnitude.

(131) Example 24 can include the subject matter of Example 16, further including: instructions that, when executed cause the processor to perform operations comprising: controlling the one or more motors to cause the hand-actuated selector to move to the neutral position.

(132) Example 25 can include the subject matter of Example 16, further including: a resilient member configured to cause the hand-actuated selector to move to the neutral position.

(133) Example 26 can include the subject matter of Example 16, further including: a stop surface configured to stop motion of the hand-actuated selector when the hand-actuated selector reaches the third threshold displacement distance from the neutral position.

(134) Example 27 can include a method to control motion of a cursor in a first two-dimensional (2D) plane based upon motion of a user input device in a second 2D plane and based upon motion of a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to the user input device, comprising: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a constant movement ratio, while the hand-actuated selector moves relative to the user input device at a rate less than a first threshold rate; causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user interface device in the second 2D plane according to a movement ratio that decreases as a function of increasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device in response to rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the controller being between the first threshold rate and a second threshold rate; and causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to motion ratio that increases as a function of decreasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device, in response to rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device decreasing below the second threshold rate.

(135) Example 28 can include the subject matter of Example 27, further including: controlling causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a second constant movement ratio that is less than the first movement ratio, in response to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a second threshold rate.

(136) Example 29 can include the subject matter of Example 27, further including: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to stop following motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane, in response to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a second threshold rate.

(137) Example 30 can include an apparatus to control motion of a cursor in a first two-dimensional (2D) image display plane in a display system based upon motion of a user input device in a second 2D haptic plane and based upon motion of a hand-actuated selector moveably mounted to the user input device, comprising: one or more sensors configured to sense motion of the hand-actuated

selector; processing circuitry; and a memory system storing instructions which, when executed by the processing circuitry, cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a constant movement ratio, while the hand-actuated selector moves relative to the user input device at a rate less than a first threshold rate; causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user interface device in the second 2D plane according to a movement ratio that decreases as a function of increasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device, in response to rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device being between the first threshold rate and a second threshold rate; and causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to motion ratio that increases as a function of decreasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device, in response to rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device decreasing below the second threshold rate.

(138) Example 31 can include the subject matter of Example 30, further including: instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a second constant movement ratio that is less than the first movement ratio, in response to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a second threshold rate.

(139) Example 32 can include the subject matter of Example 30, further including: instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to stop following motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane, in response to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a second threshold rate.

Claims

1. An apparatus comprising: one or more sensors configured to sense motion of a hand-actuated selector; processing circuitry; and a memory system storing instructions which, when executed by the processing circuitry, cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: causing motion of a cursor in a first 2D plane to follow motion of a user input device in a second 2D plane according to a first movement ratio that changes as a function of rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector, wherein the first movement ratio decreases as a function of increasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device being less than a first threshold and wherein the first movement ratio increases as a function of decreasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device being less than the first threshold; causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a second movement ratio responsive to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than the first threshold; and causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a third movement ratio responsive to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a second threshold.

2. The apparatus of claim 1, further including instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to stop following motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane, in response to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a third threshold.

3. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the third movement ratio is a constant movement ratio less than the second movement ratio.

4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the second movement ratio is a constant movement ratio.

5. The apparatus of claim 1, further including instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: using one or more filtering functions to filter controller motion.
6. The apparatus of claim 5, wherein the one or more filtering functions filter controller motion as a function of time, wherein the function of time is one of a linear function of time, a logarithmic function of time or an exponential function of time.
7. The apparatus of claim 5, wherein the one or more filtering function increase filtering of controller motion to decrease the movement ratio and decrease filtering of controller motion to increase the movement ratio.
8. An apparatus comprising: one or more sensors configured to sense motion of the hand-actuated selector; processing circuitry; and a memory system storing instructions which, when executed by the processing circuitry, cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: causing motion of a cursor in a first 2D plane to follow motion of a user input device in a second 2D plane according to a first movement ratio that changes as a function of rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector, wherein the first movement ratio decreases as a function of increasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device being less than a first threshold and the first movement ratio increases as a function of decreasing rate of movement of the hand-actuated selector relative to the user input device being less than the first threshold; causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to stop following motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane, responsive to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a second threshold rate.
9. The apparatus of claim 8, further including instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: causing motion of the cursor in the first 2D plane to follow motion of the user input device in the second 2D plane according to a third movement ratio that is less than the second movement ratio, in response to the hand-actuated selector moving relative to the user input device at a rate greater than a third threshold less than the second threshold.
10. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the third movement ratio is a constant movement ratio less than the second movement ratio.
11. The apparatus of claim 8, wherein the second movement ratio is a constant movement ratio.
12. The apparatus of claim 2, further including instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: using one or more filtering functions to filter controller motion.
13. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more filtering functions filter controller motion as a function of time, wherein the function of time is one of a linear function of time, a logarithmic function of time or an exponential function of time.
14. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more filtering function increase filtering of controller motion to decrease the movement ratio and decrease filtering of controller motion to increase the movement ratio.
15. An apparatus, comprising: one or more sensors configured to sense amount of displacement of a hand-actuated selector from a neutral position; one or more motors configured to impart haptic force to the hand-actuated selector; a stop surface to stop motion of the hand-actuated selector and a resilient member to cause the hand-actuated selector to move to the neutral position; processing circuitry; a memory system storing instructions which, when executed by the processing circuitry, cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: in response to the hand-actuated sensor at a displacement distance less than a first threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a first control state to impart a maintaining force; and in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor at a displacement distance between a first threshold distance from a neutral position neutral position and a second threshold distance from the neutral position, controlling one or more motors according to a second control state to impart a haptic force to the hand-actuated selector that increases in magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position.

16. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, the processing circuitry controls the one or more motors according to a third control state to reduce magnitude of the haptic force imparted to the hand-actuated selector to a reduced magnitude that is less than a magnitude of the haptic force imparted during the second control state.
 17. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, the processing circuitry controls the one or more motors according to a third control state wherein the haptic force decreases in magnitude to the reduced magnitude as a function of increasing displacement of the hand-actuated selector from the neutral displacement position.
 18. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the stop surface is positioned to impart a reactive force to the hand-actuated selector to stop further displacement of the hand-actuated selector when the hand-actuated selector reaches the third threshold displacement distance from the neutral position.
 19. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein in response to sensing the hand-actuated sensor has met the second threshold distance from the neutral position, the processing circuitry imparts a click event signal to cause an occurrence of the click event at a display system.
 20. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the maintaining force is less than a haptic force imparted by the one or more motors according to the second control state.
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